First News

13 Mar 2026

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

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Global, Regional Markets

U.S. stock indexes fell sharply on Thursday, March 12, 2026, as oil prices surged over 9% following intensified supply disruptions in the Middle East Brent at $101.45/bbl up 9.30% WTI up 9.72% to settle at $96,51bbl

Iran’s Supreme Leader also said other fronts will be opened if the war persists and called on regional countries to close US bases

- Strait of Hormuz Blockade: Iran's new Supreme Leader, Mojtaba Khamenei, ordered the Strait to remain closed to pressure "the enemy," effectively halting 20% of global oil flows.
- Two crude tankers, the Safesea Vishnu and Zefyros, were attacked and set ablaze in Iraqi waters on March 12, 2026, prompting a suspension of oil terminal operations.

S&P Dow Jones Indices is considering changes to the rules governing how companies are added to the S&P 500, a move that could potentially fast-track the inclusion of SpaceX once it completes an IPO

US mortgage rates just saw their biggest weekly jump since April 2025. Driven by inflation fears and conflict with Iran, the average 30-year fixed rate rose to 6.11% (up from 6%). This sudden spike adds new uncertainty to the crucial spring homebuying season

As of 3/13/26, the yield on the two-year US Treasury note has risen to 3.76% on Oil Price Shock & Inflation Fears

Brent Crude oil prices experienced extreme volatility on March 12, 2026, briefly surging above the $100 per barrel mark following reports of fresh attacks on commercial shipping in the Middle East before retreating slightly

Oman evacuated its key Mina Al Fahal oil terminal as a precaution.

- hese events, amid widening Middle East conflict, caused Brent crude to surge above $100 per barrel.

Asian stocks declined on Thursday, March 12, 2026, ending a brief rebound as Brent crude oil climbed back above $100 a barrel following an attack on two tankers in Iraqi waters.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	3/12/2026	3/13/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	47,417	46,677	-1.56%
S&P 500	6,776	6,672	-1.53%
NASDAQ	22,716	22,311	-1.78%
PCOMP	6158.33	6,113.58	-0.73%
NKY	55,025.37	54,452.96	-1.04%
SHCOMP	4133.43	4129.1	-0.10%
HSI	25,898.76	25,716.76	-0.70%
KOSPI	5609.95	5583.25	-0.48%
SENSEX	76,863.71	76,034.42	-1.08%
TWSE	34,114	33,582	-1.56%
ASX200	8743.48	8629.04	-1.31%
BURSAKLCI	1708.78	1711.01	0.13%
JCI	7389.4	7362.12	-0.37%
STI	4863.81	4855.33	-0.17%
SET	933.08	950.12	1.83%
VNINDEX	1728.34	1709.61	-1.08%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

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Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	3/11/2026	3/12/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	92.82	96.63	4.10%
Brent Crude	91.98	100.46	9.22%
Gold (Comex)	5164	5094	-1.36%
Silver (Comex)	85.21	84.3	-1.07%
Platinum Spot	2161.78	2150	-0.54%
Copper (Comex)	589.1	583.15	-1.01%
Nickel	7.8986	7.8833	-0.19%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5%	80	80	0.00%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.8%	94.5	94.5	0.00%
Coal	131.1	134.9	2.90%
Corn	460.25	462.5	0.49%
Wheat	594.75	598.5	0.63%
Cocoa	3429	3315	-3.32%
Sugar	14.25	14.38	0.91%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

Philippines

X

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control,

6113 +44.75 pts., -0.73%

Range 6,066.84 - 6,151.56

Breadth 60 (+) 125 (-) 65 (unch)

Block Php1.10B **Volume** 1.04B
Value Php8.37B

Share buyback MRSGI AGI SMPH OPM MEG SM FRUITS

52wk H: ion opm spm
52wk L: allhc atn bhi c idc pal prmx zhi

Overbought – none
Oversold – ati sm tech bpi gtcap tfhi atn rcb chp

Active	Value
ICT	1970
URC	767
MBT	442
PLUS	429
MWC	335
BDO	290
AC	217
BPI	195
SM	180

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$7.61mn
Total FB Feb	$88.178mn
YTD NFB	$313.998mn
FB	4,836,998,005.47
FS	5,290,032,744.20
NFB(S)	453,034,738.73
TOTAL	10,127,030,749.67

Foreign Funds Bought
aub ew mbt secb acen fgen mwc shlph cnpf pizza urc ac dmc gtcap sm ali dd mac sti plus mrsgi pgold ssi nikl ogp

Foreign Funds Sold
bdo bpi cbc pnb ubp alter ap crec mer mynld pcor scc sgp spnec top dnl emi smc gsmi jfc keepr monde rfm aev agi jgs lpz ltg smc areit creit filrt meg mreit rcr rlc smph glo tel cnvrg ict bloom web apx at fni px

10yr Bond	3/10/20...	3/11/2...	%Chg
PHL	6.099	6.602	8.25%
US	4.187	4.263	1.82%

Currency Pair	3/11/2...	3/12/2...	%Chg
USD-JPY	157.71	158.7	0.64%
USD-PHP	58.916	59.405	0.06%
USD-CNY	6.8695	6.8708	0.24%
EUR-USD	1.1639	1.1558	-0.35%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

RLC 17.26

- FY25 attributable net income up 9% at ₱13.47 billion yoy

PLUS 19.96

- BingoPlus: The first and leading government-approved online bingo platform. ArenaPlus: A digital sportsbook for streaming and betting on local and international sporting events. GameZone: A hub for electronic casino, specialty, and social games.

FGEN 17.62

- First Gen Boosts 2026 Capex to ₱41.7B
- Lopez-led First Gen has set aside ₱41.7 billion in capex this year, up from ₱33.5 billion in 2025, as it advances a 2,000-MW pumped storage hydropower portfolio.
- The company plans to acquire a 40% equity interest in Prime Infrastructure Capital's pumped storage portfolio for ₱75 billion, covering the 600-MW Wawa project in Rizal and the 1,400-MW Ahunan project in Laguna.
- **Analysis:** A 24.5% capex hike is aggressive but strategically sound — pumped storage is critical for grid stability as renewables scale. The partnership with Prime Infra diversifies execution risk. Watch for financing details; debt-funded capex could pressure near-term earnings. Positive long-term for FGEN.

GLO 1,610.00

- **Globe's partnership with Transcelestial will see the rollout of over 400 wireless laser links across the country over the next three years, targeting last-mile and backhaul connectivity. Transcelestial The planned rollout follows the deployment of laser technology in Visayas and Mindanao between 2024 and 2025. Notably, Transcelestial is a portfolio company of Kickstart Ventures, Globe's own corporate VC arm.**
- **Analysis:** This is a smart infrastructure play for an archipelago nation — fiber is slow and expensive across 7,000 islands. The laser link technology offers fiber-class speeds without trenching. Globe is also exploring Transcelestial's Legolas long-distance laser links, which can transmit data over distances up to 15 kilometers, pending successful testing in 2026. Globe Positive for GLO — strengthens its 5G competitive moat against PLDT-Smart.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

TEL 1,317.00

- P**LDT has announced the deployment of ERICA (Enterprise Risk Intelligence Companion Agent), an autonomous system built on its platform in partnership with UiPath.**
- The system is described as the first agentic AI application in a Southeast Asian telecommunications company, designed to identify, assess, and manage organizational risks with increased speed and consistency.
- **Analysis:** ERICA is more of a governance/efficiency tool than a revenue driver. It reflects PLDT's push to modernize operations amid competitive pressure and cost management challenges. Positive for sentiment — shows PLDT is not standing still — but limited near-term earnings impact. Neutral to mildly positive for TEL.

AVIATION

- **About 110 flights to and from the Philippines were canceled or diverted due to the ongoing Middle East conflict, according to CAAP. BusinessWorld Online Higher fuel costs and operational disruptions are the primary risks — jet fuel accounts for a significant share of airline operating costs, and higher oil prices may eventually translate to higher airfares if the increase persists.**
- The global aviation industry operates on razor-thin margins, with IATA estimating a net margin of only 3.9% for 2026, leaving little room for increased operating costs at current scale. Aerospace Global News Flight-tracking data shows cancellations across seven major Middle East airports exceeded 12,300 since Feb. 28.
- **Analysis:** Direct negative impact on Philippine carriers (Cebu Air/CEB, PAL) from rerouting costs, stranded passenger expenses, and fuel surcharge pressures. The CAB has kept fuel surcharges at Level 4 for March. Watch for Q1 guidance downgrades. Negative for CEB and PAL.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

AEV 31.00

- **Aboitiz InfraCapital has completed a major runway surface upgrade at Laguindingan International Airport, Mindanao's second-busiest airport. Works included runway repainting, rubber removal, and crack repairs. Context Starting in 2026, the airport's capacity is expected to increase to 6.1 million passengers from the current 3.9 million target.**
- Analysis: Steady execution on AIC's ₱12.75B airport concession. The runway rehab is a necessary maintenance milestone rather than a transformative event, but it signals operational discipline. Mildly positive for AEV as its infrastructure arm delivers on concession commitments.

MER 600.00

- **Meralco said it will review its fuel mix amid Middle East-driven volatility, noting supply is currently 60% gas and 20–25% coal, with potential rate impact by April, while March bills and overall supply remain unaffected.**
- **Higher input costs will raise rates since generation charges dominate the bill, complicating sentiment amid MER's ongoing rate reset application and undercollection recovery.**
- Despite the headwinds, Meralco is awaiting ERC approval on its ₱7.98B undercollection claim and expects a rate reset decision around June to July, while also seeking a tariff adjustment of ₱2.34/kWh to fund its ₱247B capex program for 2027-2030.
- **Analysis:** The share price weakness is sentiment-driven, not fundamental. Analysts view share price pullbacks as potential accumulation opportunities, given MER's regulated earnings base and limited direct margin exposure to fuel costs. The rate reset resolution (expected mid-2026) is the key catalyst. BUY on weakness for patient investors. Target: ₱607 (analyst consensus).

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

EDC
FGEN 17.62

- **First Gen is targeting initial drilling this year for a geothermal project in Indonesia, starting with one well in West Java, where electricity demand is concentrated. The initiative will be carried out in partnership with Indonesia's Sinar Mas Group through PT DSSR Daya Mas Sakti, covering fields across West Java, West Sumatra, Jambi, Central Sulawesi, and Flores with a combined target capacity of around 440 MW.**
- **Analysis:** EDC's Indonesia expansion is a significant strategic move — Indonesia holds ~40% of global geothermal reserves but has tapped only a fraction. The partnership with a well-connected local conglomerate (Sinar Mas) mitigates regulatory and permitting risk. Drilling results from the first West Java well will be a key 2026 catalyst. Positive for EDC and FGEN long-term.

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

	3/12/2026	3/13/2026	%Chg
AC	521.50	535.00	2.59%
ACEN	2.54	2.52	-0.79%
AEV	30.85	31.00	0.49%
ALI	19.00	19.14	0.74%
AREIT	40.75	39.75	-2.45%
BDO	121.70	121.50	-0.16%
BPI	102.20	102.00	-0.20%
CBC	69.20	68.50	-1.01%
CNPF	35.10	35.75	1.85%
CNVRG	13.40	13.46	0.45%
DMC	9.57	9.55	-0.21%
EMI	14.92	14.82	-0.67%
GLO	1623.00	1610.00	-0.80%
GTCAP	569.00	579.00	1.76%
ICT	730.00	695.00	-4.79%
JFC	200.00	199.00	-0.50%
JGS	25.60	25.20	

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

	3/12/2026	3/13/2026	%Chg
LTG	14.50	14.06	-3.03%
MBT	69.00	68.95	-0.07%
MER	605.00	600.00	-0.83%
MONDE	6.08	5.94	-2.30%
PGOLD	38.30	39.80	3.92%
PLUS	19.20	19.96	3.96%
RCR	7.18	7.00	-2.51%
SCC	28.40	28.65	0.88%
SM	630.00	646.00	2.54%
SMC	70.40	70.00	-0.57%
SMPH	19.60	19.76	0.82%
TEL	1330.00	1317.00	-0.98%
URC	68.90	69.60	1.02%